

Tyson Test

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USD History at Bluff View Cemetery

Many people with diverse motivations have been interested in the history of places and institutions. Some people may be ordinary citizens acting out of curiosity, some are university students and faculty members doing research, and others may work for government or historical societies. People conducting research frequently find cemeteries useful as they often inter important historical figures from local areas. A tour of Bluff View Cemetery reveals USD's institutional history. Names familiar to all university students pop out etched in the immortal store of knowledge that is the solid rock that headstones are made of. For this purpose, the following essay explores aspects of institutional history through the achievements of great people who now reside at Bluff View.

As high school students tour the University of South Dakota in their quest to choose the right school for them, they tour the many large buildings on campus. After touring the Muenster University Center (MUC), the students are led through a corridor that connects to the I.D. Weeks Library. The I.D. Weeks Library holds the largest collection of printed works in the state; it is fitting that a library as grand as ours is named after I.D. Weeks a man whose support for rural educational excellence and University administration is most worthy of note. Born in Nebraska and educated at colleges throughout the north-central US, he served as a professor of rural education in Aberdeen before being named as USD President in 1935. He served in this role for 31 years, during which enrollment at USD more than quadrupled. Upon retirement from the role of president, he served part-time as a Professor of Education and lectured at civic and religious

organizations across America (Legacy Ila I.D. Weeks). Upon his death, he was buried in Bluff View where his headstone remains. His year of birth and death as well as his tenure as USD President are noted on it; the headstone also gives his wife's year of birth and death (Dr. Ila Delbert "ID" Weeks).

As these future college students explore campus, they will come upon Old Main, one of the most architecturally meaningful buildings on campus. The Oscar Howe Art Gallery, located within Old Main, is named after an influential artist and USD Professor by the same name (Fullenkamp). Born on the Crow Creek Indian Reservation in 1915, he served in the United States Army before completing undergraduate and graduate school at Dakota Wesleyan University and the University of Oklahoma, respectively. His tenure as a professor at USD lasted 23 years, 1957-to-1980 during which generations of students would be mentored in art; the value of traditional artwork from Native Americans was emphasized by him in the Academy (Felecos). Mr. Howe's grave in Bluff View notes the dates of birth and death for both him and his wife Adelheid, a plaque of service for his time in the army during the Second World War is also present on the site (Oscar Howe).

Old Main also houses the honors program; the enrolled students represent among the best and brightest of middle America. Prospective honors students are likely to have many intellectual pursuits, among them history. One such student inquires about opportunities for additional learning. The tour guide informs him of the Herbert Samuel Schell Historical Lecture Series, named after a notable man associated with the university. Born in far-off Pennsylvania, he made his way to USD in 1925 as a Professor of History; in addition to being a professor, he was also Dean of USD's Graduate School from 1936-to-1964 as well as Chairman of the Midwest Conference on Graduate Study and Research from 1959-to-1960. He also served his country as a

visiting expert on education policy for the reconstruction of Germany and Japan following the end of the Second World War (Legacy Herbert Schell). He is buried along with his wife at Bluff View, his grave notes the date of his birth and death along with that of his wife, Mildred (Herbert Samuel Schell).

The tour group now leaving Old Main will pass by Danforth Chapel before arriving at the next building on their tour. The Akeley-Lawrence Science Center is partially named after Lewis Ellsworth Akeley. Professor Akeley was hired by the University in 1887 to teach chemistry and physics classes among other subjects. During this time, he assisted his colleague, Alexander Pell, in his efforts to establish an engineering school. In 1908, Professor Akeley became the Dean of the engineering school. He would serve in this capacity until the department was disbanded in 1933. Even in his retirement, Dean Akeley served as a part-time lecturer in Philosophy until his death at the age of 100 (Lewis Ellsworth Akeley Papers Content Description). Dean Akeley's headstone in Bluff View is most atypical compared to those of the previous men that have been described in this paper. His headstone does not show specific dates for birth and death, but rather just the year. He is buried alongside his wife, Myra, and one of their sons, Edward. Curiously, Dean Akeley is also buried next to his mother-in-law Myra B. Stowe Thomas; this may be because she died several years after her husband, who is buried in Ohio to be closer to family (Lewis Ellsworth Akeley).

Adjacent to the science center is a parking lot. This lot was the former site of Brookman and Julian Hall, which housed many University students for years. It was demolished recently to provide additional parking space (USD's Julian and Brookman Halls and Julian Addition are no more). Harold Brookman was the man who the first hall was named after. A native of Vermillion, he attended engineering school at USD before graduating in 1910; he was a well-

liked student and an athlete, serving as head of the University's track team. He also earned the reputation of being a ladies' man, which is noted in the yearbook from the following year. A patriot at heart, Brookman gave back to his country by using his engineering skills to aid the manufacture of naval equipment during the First World War. Upon completing a master's degree in Brookings and doing engineering for the US Navy, he would find employment as a USD faculty member. He taught engineering before the program was discontinued in 1933; Professor Brookman later developed a program of applied sciences and chaired that program until his 1959 retirement. He also served the wider community as a city engineer and chamber of commerce board member (Eschlenk). Professor Brookman's upright headstone at Bluff View Cemetery notes the dates of birth and death for himself and that of his wife, Ruth (Dr. Harold Edwin Brookman).

As the students make the last stop of their tour, they circle back to North Complex, where Beede Hall is to be found. Beede Hall is named after Grace Lucile Beede, an admirer of the classics, an important former faculty member of USD, and the only woman to be documented in this paper. A native of Meckling, South Dakota, she earned her bachelor's degree from USD and her Ph.D. from the University of Chicago. The publishing of her doctoral thesis speaks to her passion for classical education and the benefits that can flow from it. Her tenure at USD included time as an assistant professor of the classics from 1939-to-1947. She became a full professor in 1947 before being promoted to Chairwoman of the classics department in 1952. She would serve in that capacity until her 1970 retirement (Rutgers School of Arts and Sciences Database of Classical Scholars). In addition to her service as a professor, she was secretary for the Shrine to Music Museum and helped establish the Danforth Chapel, which the tour group passed earlier on their way to the Akeley-Lawrence Science Center. Her legacy lives on in a gallery named after

her in the National Music Museum (Legacy Grace). Dr. Beede is buried in Bluff View Cemetery, she has a simple headstone to herself, which lists her dates of birth and death. Other members of the Beede family are also buried at Bluff View, including her parents and sister (Grace Lucile Beede).

Researchers, regardless of their skill or starting point, often find a wealth of valuable information in cemeteries, as the records on the stones reveal clues about those who came before. Some of these records include people who are significant in the history of the town that the cemetery is in or an institution that the town is known for. This is as true for the University of South Dakota in Vermillion as it is for any other university or town. Many prominent people in USD's history are found in the town's main cemetery, Bluff View. By telling the history of these great people, one can learn about the evolution of the university through time.

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